ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

THA 151: Speech and Communication for Stage and Media

Voice work, articulation and delivery that survive a microphone and a hall

THEATRE & FILM

Theatre & Film Studies

Faculty of Arts
Theatre & Film Studies | 100L

OUTLINE ARCHIVE: 2018 - 2019 - 2025/2026

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Free to download. No fee, no payment step, no watermark.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

Your voice is an instrument that must be maintained and trained. This pack covers breathing and support, resonance, articulation, projection without strain, microphone technique, and the differences between stage delivery and broadcast delivery.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Support the voice with diaphragmatic breathing rather than throat tension.
- Identify and correct common Nigerian English articulation issues without shame.
- Project in a large hall without damaging the voice.
- Adapt delivery for radio, television and recorded voice-over.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Breath, support and resonance

Volume comes from breath support and resonance, not from shouting.

- Breathe low into the abdomen; shoulders should not rise.
- Control exhalation steadily to sustain a line to its end.
- Resonance chambers: chest, mouth and nasal cavities shape timbre.
- Warm up with humming, lip trills and gentle scales.
- Hydrate; avoid shouting over noise as a habit.
- Stop and rest if you feel pain or persistent hoarseness.

Articulation and accent

Intelligibility is the goal; erasing your accent is not.

- Work on final consonants, consonant clusters and word endings.
- Distinguish minimal pairs that affect meaning in your context.
- Mark stress in multisyllabic words and avoid misplaced stress.
- Pace and pausing carry meaning as much as pronunciation.
- Use tongue twisters for agility, not as a performance in themselves.
- Record yourself weekly and compare against a specific target, not a vague ideal.

> **Stage versus microphone**
> On stage you project to the back row; at a microphone you work close and controlled. Practise both, because the habits are different.

Delivery for stage and broadcast

The medium changes the technique.

- Stage: project, articulate for distance, sustain energy through long speeches.
- Radio: paint pictures with voice alone; pace and pause do the work of visual expression.
- Television: controlled energy, natural eyeline, awareness of framing.
- Voice-over: precise timing to picture, consistent tone, clean breaths.
- Interview or news reading: neutral warmth, accurate pronunciation of names.
- Always test the microphone and monitor before a recording.

Why your voice fails in a hall

Almost every "quiet" performer has the same problem: they are pushing air out with the throat instead of supporting it from the abdomen. Throat-based volume is thin, tires quickly and becomes hoarse by the second hour. Supported volume is louder with less effort because the breath stream is steady and the resonance spaces are open.

Support is mechanical, not mystical. Stand tall, let the lower ribs widen on the inhale, keep the shoulders quiet, and let the abdominal wall resist as you speak. The test is not how big a breath you can take but how evenly you can release it: count aloud on one breath and aim for a steady stream rather than a burst that collapses at eight.

Projection then depends on the space. A proscenium hall needs the voice aimed at the back wall, with consonants sharpened to carry; a small studio needs less volume and more variety. Performers who shout in small rooms damage their voices and flatten their range - the audience hears strain instead of meaning.

Articulation, accent and intelligibility

The goal of speech work is intelligibility, not the erasure of your accent. Nigerian English is a legitimate variety with its own rules, and an actor who adopts a fake foreign accent loses truthfulness. What must be controlled is clarity at speed: final consonants, consonant clusters, word endings and the placement of stress in multisyllabic words.

Most lost meaning comes from four habits: dropping final consonants ("tes" for "test"), swallowing unstressed syllables ("comftable"), misplaced stress ("deVELopment" instead of "deVELopment" in standard usage), and running words together so that boundaries disappear. Each can be drilled separately with a short list of words you personally mangle.

Pace and pause carry as much meaning as pronunciation. A pause before a name, a slight lengthening of a verb, or a faster run of clauses communicates emphasis without volume. Mark your script: breaths, pauses, stressed words, and any name or term you must pronounce correctly. A newsreader who mispronounces a name has failed at the main task, however warm the delivery.

> **Microphone technique changes everything**
> At a microphone you work close and controlled, avoid plosives by speaking slightly across the capsule, and treat sibilance deliberately. Stage habits applied to a mic produce distortion, not intimacy.

OUTLINE ARCHIVE

Session record: THA 151

2018 - 2019 - 2025/2026

Year demarcation matters: a course code that existed in 2018 may have been renumbered, merged or dropped by 2019, and the department now also runs a film track. Read the year label before you rely on a code. The current entry below is a compiled map - take it to your course rep or the departmental office and confirm it before registration.

2018 — Archived course description — ARCHIVED

- THA 151 Basic Speech and Communication for Stage and the Media
- Vocal mechanism, range, interpretive devices and voice training for the actor, public speaker, newscaster or radio presenter
- Voice integrated with body as actors hold the stage

Source: unizik.edu.ng - Theatre & Film Studies course description (page dated 31 May 2018; original URL now returns 404) (retrieved 2026-10-22)

2019 — Archived programme listing — ARCHIVED

- THA 151 Basic Speech and Communication for Stage and the Media, 3 credits
- New THA 153 Communication Models in Theatre and Media appears in the same semester
- Later media courses build on this: THA 252 and THA 324

What changed: The 2019 listing adds THA 153 as a separate communication-theory course beside the practical voice course.

Source: arts.unizik.edu.ng - Theatre Arts programme and course map (page dated 18 Oct 2019; original URL now returns 404) (retrieved 2026-10-22)

2025/2026 — Compiled working map — CURRENT WORKING MAP

- Speech and communication remains a 100-level core in the compiled map
- Broadcast and voice-over assessment is likely, given the department film track
- Confirm whether THA 153 is still taught alongside it

Source: Compiled by ZikShare from the archived 2018 and 2019 departmental pages plus the published stress areas; this is a working map, not an official handout (retrieved 2026-10-22)

Archive means: this records what a public departmental page listed in that year. It is not a guarantee of the current curriculum, and ZikShare is not affiliated with UNIZIK.

WORKED EXAMPLES

Do it once, slowly

These are not model answers to copy. They show the reasoning a strong student would use, step by step, so you can repeat the process on a question you have not seen.

1. Fixing a line that will not carry

In rehearsal your line "I will not sign it" disappears in the back half of the hall. Here is the diagnosis sequence.

1. Check breath support: are you speaking on the last third of an uncontrolled exhale?
2. Check the target: are you speaking to the other actor or to the floor?
3. Check the consonants: the t and the s in "not sign it" are what carry meaning at distance.
4. Check the tempo: rushing the line removes the stresses that make it audible.
5. Adjust one variable at a time and ask someone in the back row to repeat the line back.
6. If it still fails, change the staging, not the shout: a step downstage may solve it more cheaply.

> **What to carry forward**
> Change one variable per repetition, otherwise you cannot tell what fixed it.

2. Reading for radio

A three-minute news bulletin read. What separates a pass from a fail?

1. Mark the script for breaths, so no breath lands mid-phrase.
2. Underline stressed words; do not stress every noun.
3. Slow down on figures, names and places - the information the listener cannot re-read.
4. Keep a consistent distance from the microphone so levels do not jump.
5. Use a small pause at each story change; listeners need the boundary.
6. Record, listen back once for meaning (could you follow it?) and once for sound (any plosives, sibilance, breaths?).

> **What to carry forward**
> Radio is written for the ear: if you cannot follow your own recording, neither can the listener.

EXAM TECHNIQUE

Questions with model answers

Written in the shape your course is usually examined, with the marking logic spelled out. Attempt each one under time before you read the outline.

Q1. Explain how breath support differs from shouting, and why it matters for a stage actor.

15 marks

1. Describe supported voice: steady exhalation resisted by the abdominal wall, open resonance.
2. Describe shouting: throat tension, raised pitch, rapid fatigue, reduced intelligibility.
3. Explain the consequences: sustainability across a run, vocal health, and control of dynamics.
4. Give one practical test for support.
5. Conclude that projection is a technique of breath and target, not of effort.

> **Where marks are lost**
> Treating projection as volume. The question is about control.

Q2. Why is accent erasure not the goal of speech training?

10 marks

1. Distinguish accent from intelligibility.
2. Note that Nigerian English is a recognised variety with internal rules.
3. Explain the performance cost of imitation: loss of truthfulness and of the audience's recognition.
4. State the real targets: consonants, stress, pace and clarity at distance.

REFERENCE

Glossary

Use these definitions in your own sentences; a copied definition rarely earns full marks.

Diaphragmatic breathing. Breathing in which the diaphragm descends and the lower ribs expand, giving steady control of exhalation.

Support. The controlled release of breath against abdominal resistance that sustains voice without throat strain.

Resonance. The amplification and colouring of voice in the chest, mouth and nasal cavities.

Articulation. The shaping of speech sounds by tongue, lips and palate to make words distinct.

Projection. Directing supported voice to a specific audience distance without strain.

Plosive. A consonant produced by a burst of air, such as p, b, t, d, k, g, which can thump a microphone.

Sibilance. A harsh hiss on s and sh sounds, exaggerated by close microphone technique.

Register. The level of formality in language, from casual to formal, suited to audience and occasion.

Stress. The relative emphasis placed on a syllable or word, which can change meaning.

Intelligibility. The degree to which a listener can understand what is said, especially at distance or on recording.

Vocal warm-up. Gentle exercises that prepare breath, resonance and articulation before use.

Voice-over. Recorded speech added over picture, requiring precise timing and consistent tone.

Your four-week plan

Week 1 - Breath

Support.

- Practise low breathing for five minutes daily.
- Count aloud on one breath and record the result.
- Warm up before every rehearsal.

Week 2 - Clarity

Consonants and stress.

- List ten words you personally mangle.
- Drill final consonants in a two-minute passage.
- Record and compare with the clean version.

Week 3 - Space

Projection and target.

- Read in a large hall and have someone at the back repeat lines.
- Practise speaking to a target, not to the floor.
- Adjust volume for a small room without losing variety.

Week 4 - Media

Microphone discipline.

- Record a three-minute bulletin with breaths marked.
- Review for plosives and sibilance.
- Read the same script at two paces and choose.

Where to read more

Entry-level texts you can find in the university library or a departmental reading list. Confirm editions with your lecturer.

- Any standard voice and speech text for actors covering support, resonance and articulation.
- A broadcast journalism handbook section on reading for radio and television.
- Your department's voice studio guidelines, including vocal health advice.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. How do you know you are breathing with support?

Answer: The abdomen and lower ribs expand while the shoulders stay relatively still, and you can sustain a controlled exhalation.

2. Why is shouting a bad projection strategy?

Answer: It strains the vocal folds and produces a harsh sound that does not carry as well as supported resonance.

3. Give two differences between stage and microphone delivery.

Answer: Stage delivery requires projection to the back of the hall; microphone delivery uses close, controlled volume and greater attention to plosives.

4. What should you mark on a script before a reading?

Answer: Breaths, pauses, stressed words and any difficult names or sounds.

5. Why record yourself?

Answer: Recording exposes habits you cannot hear in the moment and allows measurable improvement against a target.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Practise diaphragmatic breathing for five minutes daily for a week.
- [ ] Warm up the voice before every studio or rehearsal session.
- [ ] Record and review a two-minute reading.
- [ ] Mark stress and pauses on one script extract.
- [ ] Practise a broadcast-style read at the microphone.
- [ ] Read a passage aloud in a large hall and check the back row can hear.
- [ ] Ask a tutor for one specific correction and apply it for a week.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

> **More from the ZikShare Academic Vault**
> Find faculty primers, study-skills guides, money and career packs, and digital-skills workbooks in the ZikShare Library. New packs are added every semester.

ZikShare Academic Vault | Theatre & Film Studies | 100L | 2026 Fresher Edition

YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date:

THA 151: Speech and Communication for Stage and Media